Jayakumar Pitchiah

PRODUCT MANAGER | PRODUCT STRATEGY, PLATFORMS & APPLIED AI

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PROFILE

Product Manager and business builder with 10 years of professional experience, including 5+ years in product management and 9+ years at KNOW. Turns complex operating needs into reusable products and commercial offerings. Combines discovery, hands-on UX and prototyping, applied-AI evaluation and cross-functional delivery, with ownership through launch, adoption and continued evolution.

EXPERIENCE

KNOW

September 2021 - Present

Product Manager

Frontline operations platform spanning operational workflows, learning, communication, scheduling, insights and asset management.

- **Commercial insights.** Defined a paid custom-reporting offering with Data and Engineering. Selected an existing visualization platform and built the initial proof of concept, limiting internal maintenance and development effort. Customers using it replaced recurring report preparation with configured views.
- **Commercial and ongoing ownership.** Recommend pricing based on customer effort and value, with CEO approval. Prioritize and coordinate integration and data-pipeline updates; Engineering and Data implement and monitor them.
- **Applied-AI delivery.** Define journeys and prototypes for Robin, voice-driven completion of existing forms and image verification. Partner with technical teams on model choices and evaluations against human-reviewed examples, including validation requirements and human-review paths.
- **Evidence-led prioritization.** Prioritized learning lifecycle improvements over a broader enhancement based on demonstrated needs and expected usage. The capability shipped, simplifying onboarding-content updates, recipient visibility and completion tracking; competing work was deferred.
- **Customer solutioning.** Challenged a requested attendance change using historical usage evidence. Recommended an existing capability instead; the customer piloted and adopted it while the original setting remained unchanged.
- **Value measurement.** Review completed workflows and repeat usage weekly, combining product evidence with customer context. Build leadership-facing value summaries from reconfirmed customer baselines and explicit assumptions, separating estimated benefits from measured results.
- **Launch enablement.** Own product materials from messaging and writing through visual presentation. Used across the company in customer communications and as internal reference, these help colleagues explain capabilities independently. Conduct training and prepare launch materials with Marketing and GTM.

EXPERIENCE - CONTINUED

KNOW
September 2019 - August 2021

Product and Operations

- **Team development.** Built and led a four-person team spanning customer delivery and product operations. Established product/process training, shared OKRs, responsibilities, performance measures and development expectations.
- **Cross-functional execution.** Coordinated Engineering, Design, QA and customer-facing teams, strengthening delivery capacity to support customers across Southeast Asia, Australia and India.

KNOW
September 2017 - August 2019

Generalist - Product, Operations and QA

- **Zero-to-one ownership.** Owned Forms and Issues from discovery through prioritization, UX, engineering coordination, testing and rollout. Launched the modules during this period and continued their evolution in subsequent roles.
- **Reusable workflows.** Shaped the Forms foundation that later supported configurable checklists, handovers, expenses, permits and audits, with conditional questions, task creation and integrations.
- **Market opportunity.** Investigated unmet scheduling needs through customer and sales-pipeline research, informing the case for shift management in retail and F&B.; Worked across onboarding, implementation, QA, support and GTM.

Crayon'd
March - August 2017

Business Analyst

- Ran discovery and translated client requirements into specifications and user flows. Coordinated stakeholder reviews and release quality checks with engineers and designers across restaurant discovery, taxation, e-commerce and fundraising products.

Stealth startup
September 2016 - March 2017

Business Analyst

- Explored an inventory-management product through market research, customer interviews and assumption validation. Built customer-specific business solutions using no-code platforms.

EDUCATION & DEVELOPMENT

Kumaraguru College of Technology
B.E., Electronics and Communication Engineering | 2012 - 2016

Product Academy Fundamentals | McKinsey & Company | 2022

Early experience: hardware and embedded-systems prototyping at iQube, a student innovation club, 2013 - 2016; Bosch trainee, May 2014.

COMMUNITY

Organizer, ProductTank Chennai; mentor to students exploring technology careers.